PROTECTED AREA NETWORK INDIA

FOUR-CATEGORY LEGAL LADDER → RIGHTS AND TENURE MATRIX → 2002 EXPANSION LOGIC → TIGER OVERLAY STACK → RELOCATION SAFEGUARD GATE → TIGER AND ELEPHANT MODELS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 FOUR-CATEGORY LEGAL LADDER

FOUR-CATEGORY LEGAL LADDER · NATIONAL PARK · STRICT STATUTORY HABITAT REGIME · WILDLIFE SANCTUARY · PROTECTED HABITAT WITH A DIFFERENT RIGHTS SETTLEMENT · CONSERVATION RESERVE · CONNECTOR OR BUFFER, GENERALLY GOVERNMENT LAND · COMMUNITY RESERVE

NATIONAL PARK → strict statutory habitat regime

WILDLIFE SANCTUARY → protected habitat with a different rights settlement → CONSERVATION RESERVE → connector or buffer, generally government land → COMMUNITY RESERVE → consent-based community or private land

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- NATIONAL PARK → strict statutory habitat regime
- WILDLIFE SANCTUARY → protected habitat with a different rights settlement

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- CONSERVATION RESERVE → connector or buffer, generally government land
- COMMUNITY RESERVE → consent-based community or private land

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- RULE → each category has its own notification and activity regime
- NATIONAL PARK → strict statutory habitat regime

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → each category has its own notification and activity regime.

01

STAGE 01 RIGHTS AND TENURE MATRIX

RIGHTS AND TENURE MATRIX · NATIONAL PARK · STRICTEST OWNER-DESCRIBED ACTIVITY REGIME · REGULATED RIGHTS MAY CONTINUE AFTER SETTLEMENT · CONSERVATION RESERVE · CONSULTATION-CENTERED GOVERNMENT-LAND ROUTE · COMMUNITY RESERVE · CONSENT PLUS LOCAL MANAGEMENT ROLE

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
NATIONAL PARK → strictest owner-described activity regime	CONSERVATION RESERVE → consultation-centered government-land route	CAUTION → read the Act and site notification before asserting a right
SANCTUARY → regulated rights may continue after settlement	COMMUNITY RESERVE → consent plus local management role	NATIONAL PARK → strictest owner-described activity regime

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER
- NATIONAL PARK → strictest owner-described activity regime
- SANCTUARY → regulated rights may continue after settlement

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- CONSERVATION RESERVE → consultation-centered government-land route
- COMMUNITY RESERVE → consent plus local management role

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
- CAUTION → read the Act and site notification before asserting a right
- NATIONAL PARK → strictest owner-described activity regime

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → read the Act and site notification before asserting a right.

02

STAGE 02 2002 EXPANSION LOGIC

2002 EXPANSION LOGIC · 1972 FRAMEWORK · NATIONAL PARKS AND SANCTUARIES · LANDSCAPE GAP · CORRIDORS, BUFFERS AND NON-STATE TENURE · 2002 AMENDMENT · CONSERVATION AND COMMUNITY RESERVES · WIDER LEGAL MENU WITHOUT ONE EXCLUSION MODEL

1972 FRAMEWORK → National Parks and Sanctuaries → LANDSCAPE GAP → corridors, buffers and non-state tenure → 2002 AMENDMENT → Conservation and Community Reserves → RESULT → wider legal menu without one exclusion model → LIMIT → category creation does not prove on-ground conservation

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- 1972 FRAMEWORK → National Parks and Sanctuaries
- LANDSCAPE GAP → corridors, buffers and non-state tenure

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- 2002 AMENDMENT → Conservation and Community Reserves
- RESULT → wider legal menu without one exclusion model

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- LIMIT → category creation does not prove on-ground conservation
- 1972 FRAMEWORK → National Parks and Sanctuaries

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → wider legal menu without one exclusion model.

03

STAGE 03 TIGER OVERLAY STACK

TIGER OVERLAY STACK · UNDERLYING LAND STATUS · NP, SANCTUARY OR OTHER NOTIFIED LANDSCAPE · TIGER RESERVE · NTCA-LINKED SPECIES-MANAGEMENT OVERLAY · CRITICAL TIGER HABITAT · COEXISTENCE AND CONNECTIVITY FUNCTIONS · OVERLAY AND UNDERLYING CATEGORY REMAIN DISTINCT

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- UNDERLYING LAND STATUS → NP, Sanctuary or other notified landscape
- TIGER RESERVE → NTCA-linked species-management overlay

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- CORE → critical tiger habitat
- BUFFER → coexistence and connectivity functions

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- RULE → overlay and underlying category remain distinct
- UNDERLYING LAND STATUS → NP, Sanctuary or other notified landscape

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → overlay and underlying category remain distinct.

04

STAGE 04 RELOCATION SAFEGUARD GATE

RELOCATION SAFEGUARD GATE · CORE-HABITAT PROPOSAL · IDENTIFY AFFECTED RIGHTS HOLDERS · VOLUNTARY AND INFORMED · APPLICABLE PACKAGE AND IMPLEMENTATION · FRA COORDINATION · TENURE-RECOGNITION PROCESS CANNOT BE IGNORED · HABITAT PROTECTION AND RIGHTS COMPLIANCE MUST TRAVEL TOGETHER

CORE-HABITAT PROPOSAL → identify affected rights holders → CONSENT → voluntary and informed → REHABILITATION → applicable package and implementation → FRA COORDINATION → tenure-recognition process cannot be ignored → VERDICT → habitat protection and rights compliance must travel together

SYSTEM INPUT / STARTING CONDITION
- CORE-HABITAT PROPOSAL → identify affected rights holders
- CONSENT → voluntary and informed

ECOLOGICAL PROCESS / TRANSFER
- REHABILITATION → applicable package and implementation
- FRA COORDINATION → tenure-recognition process cannot be ignored

OUTCOME / FEEDBACK / LIMIT
- VERDICT → habitat protection and rights compliance must travel together
- CORE-HABITAT PROPOSAL → identify affected rights holders

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → habitat protection and rights compliance must travel together.

05

STAGE 05 TIGER AND ELEPHANT MODELS

TIGER AND ELEPHANT MODELS · STATUTORY NTCA CORE-BUFFER ARCHITECTURE · WIDE-RANGING CORRIDOR AND LANDSCAPE COORDINATION · BOUNDARY FIT · STRONGER FOR BOUNDED TIGER HABITAT THAN ELEPHANT MOVEMENT · MULTI-STATE COORDINATION MATTERS FOR ELEPHANTS · RESERVE DESIGN MUST FOLLOW SPECIES ECOLOGY

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
TIGER → statutory NTCA core-buffer architecture	BOUNDARY FIT → stronger for bounded tiger habitat than elephant movement	RULE → reserve design must follow species ecology
ELEPHANT → wide-ranging corridor and landscape coordination	JURISDICTION → multi-state coordination matters for elephants	TIGER → statutory NTCA core-buffer architecture

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER
- TIGER → statutory NTCA core-buffer architecture
- ELEPHANT → wide-ranging corridor and landscape coordination

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- BOUNDARY FIT → stronger for bounded tiger habitat than elephant movement
- JURISDICTION → multi-state coordination matters for elephants

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
- RULE → reserve design must follow species ecology
- TIGER → statutory NTCA core-buffer architecture

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → reserve design must follow species ecology.

06

STAGE 06 ESZ LEGAL FIREWALL

ESZ LEGAL FIREWALL · PROTECTED AREA · WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT NOTIFICATION · ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION ACT NOTIFICATION · PA BOUNDARY · PRIMARY PROTECTED-AREA LEGAL LINE · ESZ BOUNDARY · SEPARATE SITE-SPECIFIC REGULATORY LINE

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
PROTECTED AREA → Wildlife Protection Act notification	PA BOUNDARY → primary protected-area legal line	NO UNIFORM WIDTH → read the individual notification
ESZ → Environment Protection Act notification	ESZ BOUNDARY → separate site-specific regulatory line	PROTECTED AREA → Wildlife Protection Act notification

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER
- PROTECTED AREA → Wildlife Protection Act notification
- ESZ → Environment Protection Act notification

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- PA BOUNDARY → primary protected-area legal line
- ESZ BOUNDARY → separate site-specific regulatory line

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
- NO UNIFORM WIDTH → read the individual notification
- PROTECTED AREA → Wildlife Protection Act notification

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO UNIFORM WIDTH → read the individual notification.

07

STAGE 07 THREE SPATIAL OBJECTS

THREE SPATIAL OBJECTS · NOTIFIED PROTECTED-AREA BOUNDARY · SEPARATELY NOTIFIED ECO-SENSITIVE ZONE · CORRIDOR, CATCHMENT OR SEASONAL-USE LANDSCAPE · OVERLAP IN ECOLOGY · DISTINCT IN LEGAL IDENTITY · ANSWER RULE · NEVER CALL THE WHOLE LANDSCAPE THE NOTIFIED PA

INNER → notified protected-area boundary

AROUND → separately notified Eco-Sensitive Zone → BEYOND → corridor, catchment or seasonal-use landscape → OVERLAP IN ECOLOGY → distinct in legal identity

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- INNER → notified protected-area boundary
- AROUND → separately notified Eco-Sensitive Zone

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- BEYOND → corridor, catchment or seasonal-use landscape
- OVERLAP IN ECOLOGY → distinct in legal identity

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- ANSWER RULE → never call the whole landscape the notified PA
- INNER → notified protected-area boundary

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANSWER RULE → never call the whole landscape the notified PA.

08

STAGE 08 CONNECTIVITY MECHANISM

CONNECTIVITY MECHANISM · ISOLATED HABITAT · REDUCED MOVEMENT AND DISPERSAL · CORRIDOR OR STEPPING STONE · FUNCTIONAL LINKAGE · GENE FLOW AND SEASONAL ACCESS · IMPROVED PERSISTENCE PATHWAY · OUTSIDE-PA LAND USE

ISOLATED HABITAT → reduced movement and dispersal → CORRIDOR OR STEPPING STONE → functional linkage → GENE FLOW AND SEASONAL ACCESS → improved persistence pathway → OUTSIDE-PA LAND USE → determines corridor quality → LIMIT → mapped corridor is not proof of functional connectivity

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- ISOLATED HABITAT → reduced movement and dispersal
- CORRIDOR OR STEPPING STONE → functional linkage

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- GENE FLOW AND SEASONAL ACCESS → improved persistence pathway
- OUTSIDE-PA LAND USE → determines corridor quality

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- LIMIT → mapped corridor is not proof of functional connectivity
- ISOLATED HABITAT → reduced movement and dispersal

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → mapped corridor is not proof of functional connectivity.

09

STAGE 09 BOUNDARY SAFEGUARD MAP

BOUNDARY SAFEGUARD MAP · STATE PROCESS · PROTECTED-AREA NOTIFICATION AND MANAGEMENT · STATE LEGISLATURE · OWNER-RECORDED ROLE FOR SPECIFIED BOUNDARY CHANGES · OWNER-RECORDED RECOMMENDATION OR APPROVAL SAFEGUARD · ADDITIONAL TIGER RESERVE BOUNDARY ROLE · IDENTIFY THE EXACT CATEGORY BEFORE NAMING THE AUTHORITY

STATE PROCESS → protected-area notification and management

STATE LEGISLATURE → owner-recorded role for specified boundary changes → NBWL → owner-recorded recommendation or approval safeguard → NTCA → additional Tiger Reserve boundary role

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER
- STATE PROCESS → protected-area notification and management
- STATE LEGISLATURE → owner-recorded role for specified boundary changes

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- NBWL → owner-recorded recommendation or approval safeguard
- NTCA → additional Tiger Reserve boundary role

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
- RULE → identify the exact category before naming the authority
- STATE PROCESS → protected-area notification and management

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → identify the exact category before naming the authority.

10

STAGE 10 FORMAL PA AND OECM

FORMAL PA AND OECM · FORMAL PA · STATUTORY CATEGORY UNDER WILDLIFE LAW · SUSTAINED CONSERVATION OUTCOME OUTSIDE FORMAL PA STATUS · SACRED OR WORKING LANDSCAPE · POSSIBLE OECM ROUTE, NOT AUTOMATIC STATUS · COUNTING CLAIM · NEEDS A VERIFIED RECOGNITION PROCESS

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
FORMAL PA → statutory category under wildlife law	SACRED OR WORKING LANDSCAPE → possible OECM route, not automatic status	RULE → outcome label does not silently create a legal category
OECM → sustained conservation outcome outside formal PA status	COUNTING CLAIM → needs a verified recognition process	FORMAL PA → statutory category under wildlife law

ECOLOGICAL UNIT / PARAMETER
- FORMAL PA → statutory category under wildlife law
- OECM → sustained conservation outcome outside formal PA status

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
- SACRED OR WORKING LANDSCAPE → possible OECM route, not automatic status
- COUNTING CLAIM → needs a verified recognition process

SCALE / STATUS / EXCEPTION
- RULE → outcome label does not silently create a legal category
- FORMAL PA → statutory category under wildlife law

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → outcome label does not silently create a legal category.

11

STAGE 11 EVIDENCE AND PYQ SPINE

EVIDENCE AND PYQ SPINE · PA CATEGORY, TIGER OVERLAY, ESZ, CORRIDOR OR OECM · NOTIFIED BOUNDARY AND COMPETENT AUTHORITY · RIGHTS, CONNECTIVITY AND MANAGEMENT MECHANISM · ANY COUNT, NOTIFICATION OR OVERLAY MILESTONE · DESIGNATION IS NOT VERIFIED PROTECTION OUTCOME

CLASSIFY → PA category, Tiger overlay, ESZ, corridor or OECM → FIX → notified boundary and competent authority → ADD → rights, connectivity and management mechanism → DATE → any count, notification or overlay milestone → QUALIFY → designation is not verified protection outcome

SYSTEM / LEVEL / DEFINITION
- CLASSIFY → PA category, Tiger overlay, ESZ, corridor or OECM
- FIX → notified boundary and competent authority

STRUCTURE-FUNCTION MECHANISM
- ADD → rights, connectivity and management mechanism
- DATE → any count, notification or overlay milestone

SCALE / EVIDENCE LIMIT
- QUALIFY → designation is not verified protection outcome
- CLASSIFY → PA category, Tiger overlay, ESZ, corridor or OECM

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → designation is not verified protection outcome.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE JUDICIAL SEQUENCE TO KNOW (VERIFY EXACT ORDER DATES) · READ THE SEQUENCE, NOT JUST THE ENDPOINT: THE 2022 · IMPLEMENTATION GAP · ESZ BOUNDARY FINALISATION FOR MANY PROTECTED AREAS HAS · THE TENSION IS GENUINELY TWO-SIDED · OVERLY PERMISSIVE ESZ RULES RISK EDGE-EFFECT · PROTECTED-AREA AREA/COUNT STATISTICS (NATIONAL PARKS, SANCTUARIES, RESERVES) ARE

OPTIONAL ECOLOGICAL PROCESS DEPTH
- The judicial sequence to know (verify exact order dates before citing them); in
- CAUTION: Read the sequence, not just the endpoint. The 2022 order is the strongest judicial
- CAUTION: Implementation gap: ESZ boundary finalisation for many protected areas has
- CAUTION: The tension is genuinely two-sided; overly permissive ESZ rules risk edge-effect

SCALE, PARAMETER OR STATUS LIMIT
- CAUTION: Protected-area area/count statistics (National Parks, Sanctuaries, Reserves) are
- CAUTION: "Core/critical tiger habitat" determination involves scientific criteria (habitat
- CAUTION: Human-wildlife conflict data (e.g., livestock/crop loss, human casualties near protected
- NTCA relocation guidelines require voluntary, informed consent and a defined

COMPARATIVE RESTORATION NUANCE
- Eco-Sensitive Zone extent and permissible activity have been subject to evolving
- Project Elephant has historically lacked an NTCA-equivalent statutory authority
- Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves (2002 amendment) were specifically designed
- NOT: NTCA-mandated relocation from tiger reserves is mandatory/involuntary. - Guidelines

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels